

PROTECT YOURSELF AND YOUR PASSENGERS

Seat Belts

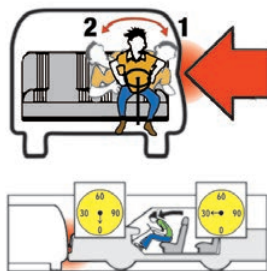
You and your passengers must wear seat belts. You can get a ticket if you do not. If your passenger is under 16 years old, you can also get a ticket if they are not wearing their seat belt.

Wearing the lap belt and shoulder harness of a seat belt will increase your chance of survival in most types of collisions. This image shows what can happen in a collision.

When you are in a collision, your vehicle stops. But you keep moving at the same speed you were traveling. You only stop when you hit the dashboard or windshield. If you are struck from the side, the impact could push you back and forth across the seat. Seat and shoulder belts keep you in a better position to control the vehicle. They may also minimize serious injuries.

It is important to wear the seat belt correctly to avoid injury or death:

- Wear the shoulder harness across your shoulder and chest. There should be little to no slack. Do not wear the shoulder belt under your arm or behind your back.
- Adjust the lap belt so that it is snug and lies low across your hips. Otherwise, you might slide out of the belt in a crash.
- If you are pregnant, wear the lap belt as low as possible under your abdomen. Place the shoulder strap between your breasts and to the side of your abdomen's bulge.



IMPACT - If the red arrow were another car hitting your car on the driver's side:

1. You would first be thrown against the driver's side door.
2. Then you would "rebound" and be thrown toward the passenger's side door.